



NOTRE DAME FIGHTING IRISH

NATIONAL FORECAST: 4 | 2025 RECORD: 10-2

OFFENSE With the departure of running backs Jeremiyah Love and Jadarian Price, quarterback CJ Carr will be the focus following his 2,741 passing yards and 24-to-6 touchdown-to-interception ratio in his debut season. Carr has the accuracy and moxie to mount a Heisman Trophy candidacy.

The Irish have an unusually high number of receivers from which to choose, led by 2025 leading receiver Jordan Faison, 2024 national championship game standout Jaden Greathouse and Micah Gilbert. Ohio State transfers Mylan Graham and Quincy Porter will also be significant factors.

The offensive line features two young rising star tackles in Guerby Lambert and Will Black. Third-year starter Anthonie Knapp shifts to left guard from left tackle. The return to health of center Ashton Craig and guard Charles Jagusah would make this a dynamic front wall.

Running backs Aneyas Williams and Nolan James Jr. won't match the Love/Price explosiveness, but both have burst and tackle-breaking ability.

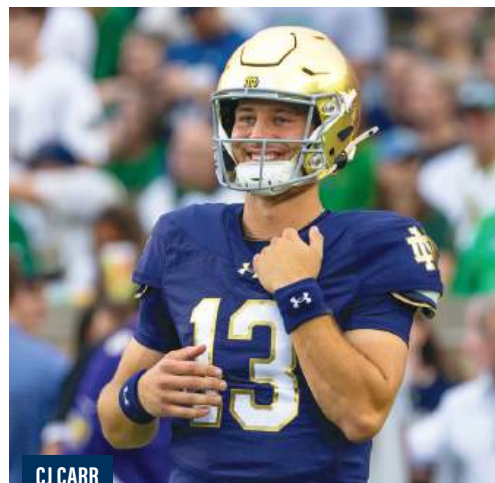
DEFENSE Second-year defensive coordinator Chris Ash has a bevy of experience returning on the back seven, where linebackers Drayk Bowen and Kyngstonn Viliamu-Asa, cornerback Leonard Moore and safeties Adon Shuler and Brauntae Johnson helped lead the Irish to the nation's No. 10 scoring defense (17.6 points per game). Notre Dame's 21 interceptions in 12 games were the fourth-most nationally.

A pair of defensive tackle transfers — powerful Francis Brewu (Pitt) and 6-foot-5, 330-pound Tionne Gray (Oregon) — join forces with returnees Jason Onye and Elijah Hughes. Defensive end Boubacar Traore is set for national acclaim, while Bryce Young should be ready to put it all together. Alabama transfer Keon Keeley, who was committed to Notre Dame before signing with the Crimson Tide, has returned to the Irish fold.

SPECIALISTS After two seasons of inconsistency, the Irish hope to stabilize their placekicking with former Purdue standout Spencer Porath, who converted 15-of-17 field goals in 2025. For the second time in three years, the Irish have turned to an Australian punter — this time, Jasper Scaife.

FINAL ANALYSIS Since their College Football Playoff snub, Notre Dame and head coach Marcus Freeman have been on the "Leave No Doubt" tour. Freeman has been relentless in his approach to get his players dialed in to right the wrong of last season. "I need to say, 'keep the pain' to get them to remember why we have to struggle and why we have to sacrifice," Freeman says. "Nothing great is achieved if you don't have that edge, that motivation to struggle and sacrifice. We have that edge." The Irish also have a favorable schedule and the firepower to run the table in the regular season.

2025 RESULTS (10-2)	2026 SCHEDULE	TOP 10 RECRUITS*
Aug. 31 at Miami (Fla.) L 24-27	Sept. 6 vs. Wisconsin #	1. Grayson McKeogh, OT ★★★★★
Sept. 13 Texas A&M L 40-41	Sept. 12 Rice	2. Rodney Dunham, EDGE ★★★★★
Sept. 20 Purdue W 56-30	Sept. 19 Michigan State	3. Khary Adams, CB ★★★★★
Sept. 27 at Arkansas W 56-13	Sept. 26 at Purdue	4. Joey O'Brien, S ★★★★★
Oct. 4 Boise State W 28-7	Oct. 3 at North Carolina	5. Ian Premer, TE ★★★★★
Oct. 11 NC State W 36-7	Oct. 10 Stanford	6. Ayden Pouncey, CB ★★★★★
Oct. 18 USC W 34-24	Oct. 17 at BYU	7. Ebenezer Ewetade, EDGE ★★★★★
Nov. 1 at Boston College W 25-10	Oct. 31 vs. Navy %	8. Jonaz Walton, RB ★★★★★
Nov. 8 Navy W 49-10	Nov. 7 Miami (Fla.)	9. Kaydon Finley, WR ★★★★★
Nov. 15 at Pitt W 37-15	Nov. 14 Boston College	10. Javian Osborne, RB ★★★★★
Nov. 22 Syracuse W 70-7	Nov. 21 SMU	
Nov. 29 at Stanford W 49-20	Nov. 28 at Syracuse	
	#Green Bay, WI %Foxborough, MA	*Per Rivals
TEAM INFORMATION		
Head Coach: Marcus Freeman • Record at School: 43-12 (4+ years) • Career Record: 43-12 (4+ years) • Offensive Coordinator: Mike Denbrock • Defensive Coordinator: Chris Ash • Location: South Bend, Ind. • Stadium: Notre Dame Stadium (77,622)		



CJ CARR

SCOUTING THE FIGHTING IRISH

"I would imagine that they take the cuffs off [quarterback CJ Carr] a little more. I thought he was very good last year, but I also thought that they asked little of him. Create isolation routes, get the ball to the right guy. Indiana did the same thing — ran the ball, created one-on-ones and took advantage of them. And [Carr] is more talented than Fernando Mendoza. That's saying a lot. ... They're so good up front that they just get after your a—. It's just hard to match up with them because you can't stop them from running the football because of how good they are up front. You put the whole team up there, and then you're gonna create one-on-ones, and they have a few receivers that they haven't had the last few years."

— An opposing assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (7)

WR	6	JORDAN FAISON (SR.)	3	Mylan Graham* (So.)
WR	1	JADEN GREATHOUSE (JR.)	17	Elijah Burress (Fr.)
WR	14	Micah Gilbert (So.)	0	Quincy Porter* (So.)
LT	74	Will Black (Fr.)	71	Charles Prescod (So.)
LG	54	ANTHONIE KNAPP (JR.)	56	Charles Jagusah (Jr.)
C	70	ASHTON CRAIG (SR.)	64	JOE OTTING (JR.)
RG	75	Sullivan Absher (Jr.)	58	Matty Augustine (Fr.)
RT	76	GUERBY LAMBERT (SO.)	78	Owen Strebeg (Fr.)
TE	87	Cooper Flanagan (Jr.)	7	Ty Washington (Sr.)
QB	13	CJ CARR (SO.)	10	Noah Grubbs (Fr.)
RB	22	Aneyas Williams (Jr.)	2	Nolan James Jr. (Fr.)

DEFENSE (8)

DE	5	BOUBACAR TRAORE (JR.)	10	Loghan Thomas (Jr.)
DT	47	JASON ONYE (SR.)	0	Tionne Gray* (So.)
DT	7	Francis Brewu* (Jr.)	56	Elijah Hughes (Sr.)
DE	95	Bryce Young (Jr.)	11	Keon Keeley* (Jr.)
ILB	34	DRAYK BOWEN (SR.)	4	JAIDEN AUSBERRY (JR.)
ILB	27	Kyngstonn Viliamu-Asa (Jr.)	3	Jaylen Sneed (Sr.)
CB	15	LEONARD MOORE (JR.)	12	Jayden Sanders* (So.)
CB		DJ McKinney* (Sr.)	24	Mark Zackery IV (So.)
NB	29	CHRISTIAN GRAY (SR.)	1	Dallas Golden (So.)
S	8	ADON SHULER (JR.)	22	Ethan Long (Fr.)
S	9	BRAUNTAE JOHNSON (SO.)	28	Luke Talich (Sr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	35	Spencer Porath* (Jr.)	KR	22	Aneyas Williams (Jr.)
P	39	Jasper Scaife (Fr.)	PR	6	Jordan Faison (Sr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER

MICHAEL CATERINA-IMAGN IMAGES



SHAMAR PORTER

SCOUTING THE HUSKIES

"[New UConn coach] Jason Candle did a great job at Toledo. Year in, year out, they were competing for the MAC Championship. It should be a smoother transition because a lot of the guys that they were recruiting in the MAC, they should be able to recruit at UConn. I absolutely know that they'll have a bigger budget, so they'll be able to take what they had done and sell it on top of what [previous head coach Jim L. Mora] was able to do at UConn during his tenure, so I don't think it'll be as big of a challenge for them to get back to where they want to be. ... There'll be some hiccups, but I just think Candle's done it for a long time at this point, so that transition will be smoother."

— An opposing assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (1)

WR	11	Ryder Treadway* (Fr.)	0	Ky Wilson* (Jr.)
WR	2	Jediyah Willoughby* (So.)	8	Zy'marion Lang* (So.)
WR	5	Shamar Porter (Jr.)	19	Javon Brown* (Fr.)
LT	76	Dominic Rivera* (So.)	78	Isiah Switzer* (Fr.)
LG	55	Andrew Laurich* (So.)	73	Raphael Greene-Nyarko* (Fr.)
C	58	Terrence Moore* (Sr.)	52	Deron McLaughlin (So.)
RG	69	TY CHAN (SR.)	62	Ben Mulholland* (Fr.)
RT	79	Christian Richter* (Jr.)	59	Finn Wilkins (So.)
TE	86	Matt Ragan* (Jr.)	80	Alex Godavitarne* (Jr.)
QB	4	Jake Merklinger* (Fr.)	7	Kalieb Osborne* (Fr.)
RB	6	Trey Cornist* (So.)	3	Kenji Christian* (Jr.)

DEFENSE (0)

DE	11	Avery Dunn* (Jr.)	52	Joshua Mickens* (Jr.)
DT	3	Esean Carter* (Sr.)	95	Melvin Hills III* (Fr.)
DT	2	Tahjae Mullix* (Sr.)	14	Desmond Aladuge* (So.)
DE	15	Anas Lugman* (Jr.)	94	Matt Hoffman (Sr.)
LB	44	John Lista* (Sr.)	18	Kyliah Hicks (Sr.)
LB	0	K'Von Sherman* (Jr.)	5	Rickey Williams* (Fr.)
LB	20	Luke Murphy* (Sr.)	9	Zakaih Saez* (So.)
CB	10	Jayden Davis* (Jr.)	6	Renick Dorilas* (Fr.)
CB	7	Tyler McKinstry* (So.)	28	Elijah Whitaker (Fr.)
S	4	Braedyn Moore* (So.)	21	Tracy Revels* (So.)
S	13	Jayden Price* (Fr.)	23	Steve Miller* (Fr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	89	Mike Baker* (Fr.)	KR	9	Julian Allen* (So.)
P	35	Spencer Sullins (Fr.)	PR	9	Julian Allen* (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



UConn HUSKIES

NATIONAL FORECAST: 103 | 2025 RECORD: 9-4

OFFENSE After a historic year for UConn offensively — its first ever with a 3,000-yard passer (Joe Fagnano), a 1,000-yard receiver (Skyler Bell) and a 1,000-yard rusher (Cam Edwards) — new head coach Jason Candle had to start from scratch. He's done so with a base of players who followed him from Toledo, including quarterback Kalieb Osborne, who is likely to compete with Tennessee transfer Jake Merklinger for the starting job, and running back Kenji Christian, who will be part of a room that includes Trey Cornist from Central Michigan and Cyncir Bowers from West Virginia.

Candle has said that he hopes to have an offense that will take shots down the field, and that should be a possibility with receivers like Ky "Flash" Wilson from FCS Youngstown State and Toledo transfers Jediyah Willoughby and Ryder Treadway. Shamar Porter is one of the few returners and provides a big target down the field.

The offensive line, with guard Ty Chan returning, is largely made up of players who helped Toledo tie for 17th nationally in sacks allowed last season.

DEFENSE The Huskies' strength under new defensive coordinator Ryan Manalac figures to be at the linebacker position, which he coached for the past five seasons at Pitt. K'Von Sherman, who had 94 tackles and 4.5 sacks last year at Toledo, figures to lead an experienced group that includes FCS Penn transfer John Lista and Luke Murphy from Coastal Carolina.

Esean Carter, another former Rocket, headlines the defensive line in his senior season and is joined by a handful of players who have waited for their opportunity, such as Joshua Mickens from Ohio State and Tahjae Mullix from Oregon State. The defensive backfield is less experienced, with a number of players, like junior safety Braedyn Moore, competing for their first full-time role in college.

SPECIALISTS The Huskies have brought in Mike Baker to kick after he spent his first two seasons as a backup at Ole Miss, only attempting and making four extra points. Spencer Sullins, who started his career at Memphis, and Australian Tommy Warner, who started his career at FCS Northwest Missouri State, are competing for the punter spot. Julian Allen, a former Toledo receiver, took most of the return reps in the Huskies' spring game, but that role has yet to be determined.

FINAL ANALYSIS UConn brought in more than 70 new players and almost an entirely new staff, but there is optimism around the program that Candle, who never had a losing season in 10 years at Toledo, will be successful in Year 1. That might not mean a third-straight nine-win season, but the foundation is there for the Huskies to remain competitive.

2025 RESULTS (9-4)

Aug. 30	Central Conn. State	W	59-13
Sept. 6	at Syracuse (ot)	L	20-27
Sept. 13	at Delaware (ot)	L	41-44
Sept. 20	Ball State	W	31-25
Sept. 27	at Buffalo	W	20-17
Oct. 4	FIU	W	51-10
Oct. 18	at Boston College	W	38-23
Oct. 25	at Rice (ot)	L	34-37
Nov. 1	UAB	W	38-19
Nov. 8	Duke	W	37-34
Nov. 15	Air Force	W	26-16
Nov. 22	at Florida Atlantic	W	48-45
Dec. 27	vs. Army #	L	16-41

#Fenway Bowl

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 5	Lafayette
Sept. 12	Maryland
Sept. 19	at Southern Miss
Sept. 26	at Miami (Ohio)
Oct. 3	Syracuse
Oct. 10	at Temple
Oct. 24	UMass
Oct. 31	at Air Force
Nov. 7	North Carolina
Nov. 14	James Madison
Nov. 21	Old Dominion
Nov. 28	at Wyoming

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1. Jackson Mangham, TE	★★★★
2. James Tilus, EDGE	★★★★
3. Owen Winder, OT	★★★★
4. Makijah Latiker, DL	★★★★
5. Zikhere Leaks, WR	★★★★
6. Jayden Jones, LB	★★★★
7. Cason Dash, CB	★★★★
8. Shmar Akande, CB	★★★★
9. Rodarion Tellez, EDGE	★★★★
10. Grant Blascak, S	★★★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Jason Candle • Record at School: First Season
Career Record: 81-44 (10+ years) • Offensive Coordinator: Nunzio Campanile
Defensive Coordinator: Ryan Manalac • Location: Storrs, Conn.
Stadium: Pratt & Whitney Stadium at Rentschler Field (36,000)